

The 6:15

SUNDAY · AUGUST 30, 2026

NO. 9

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS) · WEEKEND FORMAT

Ahead	House vote (date TBD, before 9/30) on the Senate's Collins-Murray CR, passed 90-6, funding govt. at FY26 levels through 12/11 and averting an Oct. 1 shutdown · Fri 9/4 Aug. jobs report, 8:30a (BLS) · Mon 9/7 Labor Day, markets closed · Tue 9/8 Canada's retaliatory tariffs on ~\$27.6B of U.S. imports take effect · Fri 9/11 Aug. CPI, 8:30a · Wed 9/16 FOMC decision — hike odds 57-59% (CME FedWatch), up from 34-35% pre-Warsh.
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METRICS · WEEKEND FORMAT, ET UNLESS NOTED

Equities/Vol	Fri close (last print; markets shut through the weekend, next session Mon): S&P 500 7,711.76 (-0.25%), Dow 53,559.99 (-0.02%), Nasdaq 26,402.42 (-0.52%), VIX 14.43 (-0.55%). Asia Fri: Nikkei 66,405.56 (+0.41%), Hang Seng 25,584.79 (+0.07%).
Rates/Oil/FX/Gold	2Y ~4.34-4.38%, 10Y ~4.72-4.73%, 30Y ~5.19-5.21% Fri (vendor prints diverge slightly, no single clean close located). DXY 99.5-99.7 (prints disagree). Brent \$88-89/bbl, WTI ~\$83/bbl Fri, both down roughly 5% on the week (no clean ICE/NYMEX settle located this run). Gold \$4,450-4,630/oz (prints disagree by ~\$180, no consensus this run). Retail gas \$4.081/gal natl. avg (AAA, 8/29), flat w/w.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 182 (straits.live, as of 8/30 1017Z)
Transits	PortWatch's latest (8/23): 3/day vs. ~85/day pre-crisis baseline — 4% of normal volume. Lloyd's List: 114 crossings 17-23 Aug, +30% w/w (42 westbound vs. 29 prior week). Different windows/methodologies — see Lead

Strikes	Al Salam II hit Wed 8/26 (JMIC Update 090, eastbound near Jazirat Tawakkul; crew safe, unattributed) — most recent confirmed strike. None logged past 24h. Running total not available this run (not verified) .
Dark tankers	65 of 255 screened (25.5%) show AIS gaps (straits.live) — larger screened pool than last issue's 240, not directly comparable
War-risk premium	~\$10.0M/VLCC transit, ~40x pre-crisis (straits.live) — unchanged from Thu/Fri

Methodology, unchanged: Lloyd's List's weekly AIS aggregation, PortWatch's baseline-indexed daily snapshots, and Kpler's near-real-time counts measure different populations over different windows — never netted or averaged against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Split Sat. 8/29 DH vs. Red Sox: lost Gm 1, 6-0; won Gm 2, 9-2. 77-59, 2nd AL East, holds AL's No. 1 Wild Card.
Knicks	No move. Hart extension (3-yr, reported range narrowing toward \$54-62M) still unsigned.
Northwestern	No move. Opens season Sat. 9/5, 7p CT vs. South Dakota State (Big Ten Network).

LEAD

DIVERGING TAPE

Crude heads for a ~5% weekly loss as transit data undercuts the strait's "closed" framing

Brent and WTI both slid through the week into Friday's close, with crude wraps putting the weekly loss at "over 5%" and "near 5%" respectively — a bigger move than the headline Hormuz closure narrative would predict on its own. Brent traded as low as \$87.98 by one quote and as high as \$89.30 by another Friday, with straits.live's own snapshot (1017Z Saturday) showing \$88.10; WTI's last clean print was Thursday's \$83.53 official settle, with Friday trade in the \$83.00-83.28 range. No single clean ICE Brent or NYMEX WTI

settle for Friday was located this run **(flag)**, so this brief is reporting the range rather than picking one. [NEW]

Mechanism: EnergyNow's Friday wrap attributed the slide explicitly to a shift in how traders are reading the crisis — "increasingly view[ing] the Iran situation as an economic/sanctions confrontation rather than an imminent threat to physical supply." [read, single-sourced] That read has actual transit data behind it, but the data itself splits by vendor in a way this brief has flagged before and now has a sharper example of. Lloyd's List Intelligence counted 114 transits through the strait Aug. 17-23 — more than 30% above the prior week — with 42 westbound crossings versus 29 the week before: a real, counted pickup in traffic. Sitting right next to it: the World Bank-backed PortWatch project's snapshot for Aug. 23 alone, just 3 vessels against an ~85/day pre-crisis baseline, or roughly 4% of normal — the same figure [straits.live](#)'s live tracker was still citing as of this morning. Both numbers are real; they are not measuring the same thing. Lloyd's List is a weekly aggregate of AIS-visible transits across the whole strait; PortWatch is a baseline-indexed read of a single day's throughput. A "busier week" (Lloyd's List) and "still historically closed" (PortWatch) can both be true simultaneously, and Friday's oil market spent the session trading the direction implied by the former rather than the level implied by the latter. [NEW, fact + read]

Second-order consequence: a genuine loosening at the strait, even a partial one, matters more to the Fed right now than it does to shippers. The Sept. 11 CPI print is the last inflation read before the Sept. 16 FOMC decision that Fed Chair Warsh's Friday Jackson Hole speech repriced to 57-59% hike odds (CME FedWatch), up from roughly a third the day before. Retail gasoline was already flat

on the week at \$4.081/gal national average (AAA, Aug. 29) even before Friday's crude slide had time to pass through pump prices. If the Lloyd's List read holds up rather than proving a one-week blip — and this brief has no basis yet to say which it is — a further leg down in crude would be one of the few genuinely disinflationary inputs available to a Fed chair who spent Friday building the hawkish case. [read, continuity: ties directly into Saturday's Warsh lead]

The strait itself was otherwise quiet. The only attributed strike since the last issue was Wednesday's hit on the Kuwaiti-flagged tanker Al Salam II (IMO 9328168), struck above the waterline while transiting eastbound near Jazirat Tawakkul; crew safe, fire extinguished, no group has claimed responsibility (JMIC Advisory Update 090). [NEW, fact] Friday-into-Saturday again passed with no new strikes logged, extending the quiet window flagged in the last issue. Dark-tanker activity held at 65 of 255 screened vessels, and war-risk insurance was unchanged at roughly \$10.0 million per VLCC transit, about 40x pre-crisis — underwriters, in other words, are not yet pricing this week's transit uptick as durable. [fact]

POLITICS

Congress moved to defuse the Sept. 30 government-funding cliff before markets had to start pricing it: the Senate passed a Collins-Murray continuing resolution 90-6 that holds spending at FY26 levels roughly ten weeks into FY27, through Dec. 11, and extends surface-transportation funding alongside it. [NEW] The bill now goes to the House; Senate leaders' stated rationale for moving early was to keep the government funded past the November midterms rather than negotiate through the September deadline crunch. No

House floor date has been confirmed **(not verified this run)**. Separately, Fed Governor Lisa Cook's mortgage-fraud dispute with the White House sits exactly where Wednesday's letter left it — her attorneys turned the allegations back on Trump's, Bessent's and Blanche's own mortgage paperwork, and no White House response has surfaced. [continuity: unchanged since Wed., carried only because the clock is still running]

GEOPOLITICS

Russia and Ukraine pushed the infrastructure war further from the front line over the weekend. Ukrainian drones struck an oil refinery at Kirishi in Russia's Leningrad region overnight Saturday — roughly 75 miles southeast of St. Petersburg and well outside the zone this campaign had mostly stayed within — with a separate explosion reported in Bryansk's Bezhitsky district. [NEW] Russia's air-defense ministry said it downed 125 of 130 drones Kyiv launched Saturday night; Russian forces hit Dnipropetrovsk's Nikopol district more than 20 times overnight with drones and artillery, damaging an enterprise and a supermarket. [fact] President Zelensky used the weekend to press for a step-change in Ukraine's own campaign, calling for 1,000 long-range drone strikes on Russia daily, up from what he put at a roughly 300/day current average [read: a stated target, not yet a demonstrated capability]. Xi's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar; no new movement on export controls surfaced this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the transit-count divergence covered in the Lead, little else moved strait-side this run. The Al Salam II strike (Wed., JMIC Update 090) remains the most recent attributed incident; the prior week's Metro Venetian attack is still unclaimed. [continuity] No fresher status was located on the detained tanker Amara past its Aug. 17 stop near Qeshm Island — neither Iran nor the UAE has confirmed the detention publicly, and AIS data shows only that the vessel stopped and circled for 12-plus hours before losing signal **(unconfirmed)**. Iran's deputy foreign minister repeated this week

that "no ship can transit the Strait of Hormuz without Iran's coordination," a line straits.live logged in today's update alongside a note that U.S.-Iran talks on reopening the strait remain conditional. [fact] The site's Crisis Pressure index sits at 91/100, unchanged in direction from recent issues.

SPORTS

Yankees	Split Sat. DH vs. Red Sox (L 0-6, W 9-2). 77-59, holds AL's No. 1 Wild Card.
Knicks	Off-season. Hart extension still unsigned.
Northwestern	Off-season. Opens Sat. 9/5 vs. South Dakota State.

Continuity. Weekend edition: Metrics/Calendar condensed per format; Economics, Business and Technology cut — nothing broke in any of the three this run. Dropped as unchanged since 8/29: Marvell/Nvidia AI-capex read, Anthropic S-1 status (still unfiled), Metro Venetian non-attribution, Cook/White House silence (carried briefly under Politics only for the running clock), Oman-Iran talks. No verified rocket-launch, frontier-AI-release, VC-round, or primary-election item fell in the prior 24-48h window this run.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.